ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Gavin Maxwell	The extract is taken from Gavin Maxwell's book about his life with otters.
2	**(a)** air, with the otter packed in a box	He flew from Basra to London with Mij in a box prepared for the journey.
3	**(b)** The box was torn open by the otter.	'Was torn ... by' is passive.
4	**(b)** the marshlands of southern Iraq	He lived near the Tigris-Euphrates marshes and got the otter there.
5	**(b)** Mij got out of his box and she helped to look for him	Mij escaped from the box in the cabin and she helped to look for him.
6	**(b)** which	A relative pronoun for an animal.
7	**(c)** wanted to keep him as a pet	He had grown fond of the animal and wanted him with him.
8	**(b)** the bath filled with water	He loved water, and the bath was a delight.
9	**(b)** tame	Tame = domesticated.
10	**(a)** Mij	The author often calls him Mij.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	In the marshes of southern Iraq (1), where otters live among the reed beds and water channels (1).	1+1
12	He stayed calm and moved gently (1) so that the animal would not panic (1).	1+1
13	A rubber ball (1), which he rolled and chased with great enthusiasm (1).	1+1
14	The otter was a wild animal and could not travel like luggage (1), so a strong box with air holes was prepared (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He had grown very attached to the young otter in Iraq (1). He wished to give it a home and observe its habits closely (1). So he arranged a flight with a specially prepared box (1).	1+1+1
16	He dived and rolled in the water (1). He splashed so much that the floor was flooded (1). His happiness proved that he belonged in water (1).	1+1+1
17	The story begins in the marshes of southern Iraq (1). Water, reeds and wildlife surround the author (1). This is the natural home from which Mij is taken (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It was a strong wooden box with holes for air (1). The otter had to breathe and still be kept safe (1). Maxwell trusted that Mij would be quiet inside it (1).	1+1+1
18	Otters are natural swimmers who love water (1). They play with sheer enjoyment (1). They are full of energy and curiosity (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Mij is wild yet behaves like a friend (1). He plays with Maxwell and trusts him (1). Kindness, not force, makes this possible (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Mij is packed into a box with air holes (1). Midway he clawed through the wood and entered the cabin (1). Passengers and crew were startled while Maxwell tried to recapture him (1). With calm persistence he succeeded and prevented any injury (1). The incident shows the author's patience and the otter's untamed curiosity (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Mij explores each room (1). He is thrilled by the bathtub (1). He splashes and rolls in water (1). He plays with the ball and other objects (1). Maxwell watches him with delight (1).	2+2+1
20	Mij is young, lively and endlessly curious (1). He is a born swimmer who adores water (1). He turns every object into a plaything (1). Despite his wildness, he trusts and likes his master (1). He is mischievous but never cruel, which makes him lovable (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The loose otter in the cabin is comic (1). The alarm of the passengers is amusing (1). Mij's water games in the bath add laughter (1). Maxwell's understatement is humorous (1). Humour makes the bond believable (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** he splashed and played joyfully, flooding the floor	He played so wildly that water spilled all over.
2	**(b)** The air-hostess said that she was afraid of that animal.	Pronoun, tense and demonstrative change.
3	**(c)** a wooden box with air holes	A box with holes was made so the animal could breathe.
4	**(c)** full of energy and fun	His joy in water showed playfulness.
5	**(a)** otter	Otters are semi-aquatic mammals.
6	**(b)** box	Mij was packed in a box for the flight.
7	**(b)** treat objects as toys	Otters love playing with objects.
8	**(d)** Gavin Maxwell	The otter chapter is drawn from it.
9	**(c)** tore his way out of the box and caused a commotion	He ripped the box and emerged to the surprise of the passengers.
10	**(d)** treat almost anything as a toy	He turned things into playthings.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The otter had torn open the box and was loose in the cabin (1), and they had never travelled with such a fellow passenger (1).	1+1
12	That otters are intelligent and playful (1) and that they turn nearly any object into a toy (1).	1+1
13	The otter clawed and chewed his way out (1) and appeared in the aircraft cabin to everyone's surprise (1).	1+1
14	He rushed in and played with the water (1) with such delight that the floor was flooded (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Mij grew restless and worked at the box until it broke (1). He suddenly appeared in the passenger cabin (1). Maxwell had to deal with alarmed passengers and recapture him (1).	1+1+1
16	He says an otter treats almost anything as a plaything (1). Mij pushed, rolled and tossed objects about (1). This shows an inquisitive, creative mind (1).	1+1+1
17	Use a stronger, metal-lined box (1). Keep the box with attentive crew (1). Inform the airline and passengers beforehand (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He kept his temper and moved slowly (1). He did not shout or hurt the otter (1). This shows his patience and genuine love for animals (1).	1+1+1
18	The author narrates the escape and the flooded bath with a smile (1). It makes a possibly frightening story light (1). It also shows his affection for Mij (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Maxwell said that he would keep Mij in the bathroom that night (1). 'Shall' becomes 'would' and 'tonight' becomes 'that night' (1). Own correct example (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Maxwell is a patient lover of animals (1). He stays calm during crises such as the escape (1). He has a sense of humour and does not blame the otter (1). He is observant, noting the habits of otters closely (1). He balances affection with respect for wildness (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Open by stating wildlife has a right to live (1). Mij shows animals are sensitive (1). Habitats are lost by human action (1). Kindness leads to understanding (1). Close with an appeal to protect nature (1).	2+2+1
20	Kindness builds trust even with wild creatures (1). Mij accepted Maxwell as a friend (1). Maxwell accepted Mij's mischief without anger (1). Neither tried to dominate the other (1). Such a bond enriches both lives (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Maxwell's love is real but Mij is a wild creature (1). Confinement may harm him (1). A pet needs space and water (1). Experts must handle such animals (1). Conclusion: observation in nature is better, with rare exceptions (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
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- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** affectionate and humorous	Maxwell writes with warmth and wit.
2	**(b)** alarm and curiosity	People were startled by the animal in the cabin.
3	**(c)** he was wild by nature yet trusting	Wild yet affectionate toward the author.
4	**(c)** metaphor	A direct comparison without 'like' or 'as'.
5	**(b)** anxious	He feared harm to the animal and trouble from others.
6	**(a)** noisy confusion	A commotion is a state of noisy disturbance.
7	**(a)** providing toys and space to play	He offered healthy outlets for his energy.
8	**(a)** strong and resourceful	He tore his way out of the box.
9	**(c)** wildly anxious	Frantic = frenzied with worry.
10	**(c)** the bond between a man and a wild animal	It shows friendship and understanding.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He cares for the otter patiently (1) and describes his antics with humour and warmth (1).	1+1
12	They were alarmed (1) and some were curious about the strange animal moving between the seats (1).	1+1
13	It reveals the otter's love of water and play (1) and shows how Maxwell tolerated his mischief with joy (1).	1+1
14	The narrator is Gavin Maxwell (1) and the animal is the otter Mijbil, or Mij (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Mij tore his way out of the box during the flight (1). The air-hostess helped to look for him (1). Mij soon came running back to Maxwell (1).	1+1+1
16	When Mij tore the box and ran into the cabin (1). When he had to be found among alarmed passengers (1). Both times Maxwell stayed calm and managed the situation (1).	1+1+1
17	The floor was flooded by the otter (1). The object becomes the subject (1). The verb takes 'was' plus the past participle (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He provided a place to rest (1). He let Mij explore the rooms freely (1). He gave him water and toys to play with (1).	1+1+1
18	It is a bond of trust (1). Mij accepts Maxwell as a friend and companion (1). Maxwell respects Mij's wild nature while loving him (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Any three suitable words such as 'darted', 'rolled', 'splashed' (1). Each used correctly in a sentence (2).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Date and heading (1). The flight, the broken box, the passengers' alarm (1). The help of the air-hostess (1). Mij's joy in the bath and the water from the tap (1). Closing thoughts of relief and affection (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct dialogue format (1). Hostess reports the missing otter (1). Maxwell explains calmly (1). She helps to search (1). Mij returns and both feel relieved (1).	2+2+1
20	Proper letter format (1). Describe a calm flight disturbed by the otter (1). Explain the author's calm behaviour (1). Your feelings of fear then amusement (1). Close with a reflection and signature (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The title names the central character (1). The chapter is built around the otter's behaviour (1). It sets a lively, animal-focused tone (1). Another title: 'An Otter on the Move' (1). Reason: it captures the journeys and adventures (1).	2+2+1

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